Verbal Communication

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- **Verbal Communication**
- Verbal communication is perhaps the most obvious and understood mode of communication, and it is certainly a powerful tool in your communication toolbox. Simply, verbal communication is the sharing of information between two individuals using words.

➡ **Spoken vs Written Communication**

- While we typically focus on speech while talking about verbal communication, it's important to remember that writing is also a form of verbal communication. After all, writing uses words too!
- Imagine for a moment that you're a college student who is struggling with material in a class. Rather than simply giving up, you decide that you're going to ask your instructor for the guidance. Now, you have a few choices for using verbal communication to do this.

- You might choose to call your instructor or talk to them in person after class or during office hours. You may take a different approach and send them an email. But really, what's the difference between writing and talking in these situations?

1. **Formal versus Informal:** We generally use spoken communication informally while we use written communication formally.
2. **Synchronous versus Asynchronous:** Synchronous communication is communication that takes place in real time, such as a conversation with a friend. In contrast, asynchronous communication is communication that is not immediate and occurs over longer periods of time, such as letters, email, or even text messages.

- **3. Recorded versus Unrecorded:** Written communication is generally archived and recorded for later retrieval while spoken communication is generally not recorded.

Benefits of Spoken Communication (note)

- Spoken communication can be a conversation, a meeting, or even a speech. Spoken communication is powerful. You encode your thoughts into the spoken word and look to your audience to decode and take the message in. You can ask for feedback directly to confirm understanding of your message.